Billy Hunt

AI Engineering Leader · Agentic Systems & Delivery

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SUMMARY

Engineering leader who takes agentic AI from pilot to approved, governed and measured use inside regulated organizations, and builds hands-on with agentic coding tools every day. 20+ years in software and team leadership. Currently leading AI delivery and mainframe modernization for New Jersey's unemployment system at Nava PBC: helped NJ DOL through its first security approval of an agentic AI coding tool, open-sourced the Terraform module that runs Claude Code inside an agency's own AWS boundary, and put an LLM system into production on ~45,000 appeals cases a year.

CORE STRENGTHS

Leadership: AI strategy and adoption, team scaling, executive and government stakeholder management, mentoring engineering leaders

AI & agentic: Claude on Amazon Bedrock, Claude Code, MCP servers, agentic workflows, RAG, LLM evaluation, open-weight models

Platform & governance: AWS (Lambda, OpenSearch), Terraform, Python, TypeScript, PostgreSQL; AI coding policy, IRS 1075, NIST 800-53

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Nava PBC — 2020–Present

Principal AI Engineering Lead, Team Pegasus & M-MAT — **2026–Present**

Lead AI strategy and architecture for New Jersey's unemployment system across Pegasus (AI special projects) and M-MAT (Mainframe Modernization Acceleration Team). Scope expanded by executive direction to speed mainframe replacement through AI.

- **Took an LLM system to production for a state agency.** Shipped Aida, a decision-drafting system for NJ appeals examiners (Claude on Amazon Bedrock, RAG over NJ law): ~30 examiners, ~45,000 cases/year, every draft scored against a 7-criterion rubric with stratified human review.
- **Cut an estimated 9-person-year effort to months.** Led AI-assisted documentation of ~1,000 COBOL modules, now the baseline for the modernization roadmap.
- **Helped NJ DOL approve agentic AI coding.** Supported the launch of NJ DOL's AI Coding Rules of Conduct and the department's first security approval of an agentic AI coding tool, briefing up to the Acting Commissioner.
- **Built reusable government AI infrastructure.** Open-sourced terraform-aws-claude-code-bedrock, which runs agentic coding inside an agency's own AWS boundary with per-developer cost attribution; adopted by the NJ Office of Innovation. Grew Finchy into a multi-channel RAG platform at about 1% of Aida's cost.
- **Built internal agent tooling with safe boundaries.** Wrote an MCP server for Nava's ERP that maps a 1,267-operation API into safe-read tools with human-review write boundaries. Created nava-quicklaunch, a serverless platform that turns AI-built tools into secured sites in minutes; it hosts 6+ apps, including C-suite dashboards.
- **Drove AI adoption across the company.** Run weekly AI Engineering Office Hours for Nava's ~300-person engineering org, coach colleagues from analysts to executives, and helped write Nava's AI use policy.

Principal Software Engineering Manager & Engineering Contract Lead — **2023–2025**

New Jersey Unemployment Modernization

- **Doubled the program.** Co-led the team modernizing New Jersey's unemployment system as it grew from ~50 to ~100 people.
- **Turned team morale around.** Raised the team's employee Net Promoter Score from 13 to 55.
- **Delivered for residents.** Shipped New Jersey's new unemployment Intake Application and cut its P99 latency from 15+ minutes to under 1 second; the modernization won a 2024 Government Experience Award.
- **Set the modernization architecture.** Designed the state's mainframe modernization approach, pairing existing tooling with modern cloud systems, and built the program that trains state staff to take over the new system.
- **Owned security compliance.** Led compliance with IRS Publication 1075, NIST SP 800-53 and 2 CFR 200 for systems holding PII and FTI.

Engineering Team Lead / Senior Software Engineer — **2021–2022**

Department of Justice: ADA.gov Modernization & Civil Rights Portal

- Led all of Nava's DOJ work and delivered the new ADA.gov, winner of the Service to the Citizen Award.
- Made civilrights.justice.gov 5x faster and cut the backlog of unanswered reports by 80%.

Senior Software Engineer — **2020–2021**

Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services: CMS Cloud

- Built APIs, front end and high-availability AWS infrastructure for cloud.cms.gov; set up Nava's first QA process and CI/CD.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE & EDUCATION

Senior Front-End Developer / UI Designer, Astraea · UI Developer, Silverchair Information Systems · Full-Stack Developer, Center for Open Science · Founder of Powhatan Studios and Billy Hunt Photography (clients including The Washington Post)

B.S., Computer Science, James Madison University · AWS Certified AI Practitioner · Nielsen Norman Group UX Certification